discussions, lasting several hours. Investigations revealed that some of the students at the hostel had become suspicious. They thought that perhaps Geelani and the Jordanian student were hatching some conspiracy,' an investigating official said.[11]

The investigation agencies were now clearly desperate to construct the image of Geelani as a big-time terrorist, and for this they were now trying to find some international links. They had planted stories that he had links in Pakistan but they knew it would not be long before the falsehood was exposed. They therefore tried to invent other international connections, and this time they tried to mystify his friendship with a Jordanian student. In the middle of the *Hindustan Times* story there is a box entitled 'Professor's Proceeds'. This is the first time the 'lecturer' becomes a 'professor'. I reproduce the box:

- Gilani recently purchased a house for Rs 22 lakh in west Delhi.
- Delhi police are investigating how he came upon such a windfall.
- The terrorists who planned the operation were flushed (*sic*) with funds.
- Before carrying out the attack on Parliament, the terrorists had sent back to Srinagar Rs 10 lakh of unspent money and a laptop.[12]

As against all these statements, the actual facts are:

. Geelani does not have property in Delhi. In fact, many months later, after he was acquitted, journalists in Goa even alleged that he had gone to Goa to look at his 'ancestral property' at Divar Island.
. The court records show that no money was recovered from him except for Rs 700, which were seized from his wallet at the time of his arrest.

On 18 December 2001, *Rashtriya Sahara* in its Hindi edition carried a story by Sujit Thakur titled '*Aligarh Se England Tak Chhatron Mein Aatankwad Ke Beej Bo Raha Tha Geelani*' (Geelani was sowing the seeds of terrorism among students from Aligarh in England). The sub-title beneath this headline is: '*Jaish- e-Mohammad ne sonpa tha Bharat mein bauddhik aatankwad ki jadein jamane ka jimma'* (Jaish-e- Mohammad had entrusted him with the responsibility of spreading intellectual terrorism in India). The story by Sujit Thakur reads:

Sansad Bhawan parisar par hue aatankwadi hamle ki koshish ki saazish mein shamil Zakir Hussain College ke shikshak Abdul Rahman Geelani Bharat mein bauddhik aatankwad ki jadein jamana chahta tha. Sootron ke anusaar Bharat mein aatankwad ko bauddhik samartban